
5. Look for income opportunities

My grandparents took in boarders, although my dad, still young at the time, didn't really like having strangers in the house. My husband's grandparents also had boarders, but the kids, then young adults, enjoyed the company. At some point, both of my grandmothers worked outside the home to bring in money for their families.



Frugality can go only so far. Cold cash is often needed to pay for basic supplies, such as food and clothing, or simply to make payments on credit card debt.

6. Get government-sponsored training

My father-in-law's oldest brother joined the Civilian Conservation Corps. He worked and lived in a camp in Oregon, and learned job

skills. Back home, he first worked as a candy salesman and then started an auto-parts store and trained his younger brother in business. Eventually, they both operated stores in small towns. My dad and father-in-law were fortunate to get college degrees on the GI Bill.

Today, taking classes at the community college is an inexpensive way to get work skills. Many community colleges also offer consultation for starting and running small businesses.

7. Stay put

My dad's parents lost their house to foreclosure. But, because no one else could afford to buy the home, they were able to stay in the house. They happened to live near the downtown area of a large city with work, schools, and stores within walking distance, so it made sense to stay where they were.

8. Move to where the jobs are

My father-in-law's family (his parents and brothers) moved to Newport News so that they could work in the shipyard (my father-in-law stayed back until he could finish high school and then joined them).

Obviously, this tactic seems to be in direct contrast to #7, and was useful only when World War II efforts